

# Soloviev's \$1.8B Refi Shows Trophy Office Debt Is Available, but Only for the 100% Leased

Bank of America's \$1.8 billion loan on 9 West 57th Street signals that liquidity is returning for irreplaceable assets with proven cash flow.

The most important number in Soloviev Group's \$1.8 billion refinancing of 9 West 57th Street is not the loan amount. It is the occupancy rate. The tower is essentially 100% leased. That is not a recovery story. It is a selection story. Bank of America is not betting on the office market broadly.

It is betting on a single irreplaceable asset with a rent roll that includes Apollo Global Management, Chanel, and a tenant paying \$340 per square foot - possibly the highest rent ever recorded in New York City. When Stefan Soloviev took control of the property in 2020 after his father Sheldon Solow passed away, the building was 50% available in the middle of a pandemic. Five years later, it is full.

The leasing trajectory alone explains why Bank of America was willing to lead a \$1.8 billion refinancing at a time when most office assets cannot get a bank to return a phone call. The capital stack here is straightforward: a single institutional lender providing a large loan against a stabilized, fully leased trophy asset in a prime Manhattan location.

There is no syndication risk, no club deal complexity, no private credit bridge structure. Bank of America is holding the paper because the cash flow is visible, the sponsor is credible, and the basis - while not disclosed - is almost certainly conservative relative to the building's replacement cost and income potential. This is not a vote of confidence in office.

It is a vote of confidence in this building, this sponsor, and this income stream. The distinction matters because it reveals how capital is allocating in the post-2024 office market. Liquidity has returned, but only in narrow lanes: assets with defensible cash flow, sponsors with balance-sheet credibility, and debt structures that can survive another year of expensive money.

The \$340 per square foot lease to investment firm HBeyond is the kind of data point that makes an underwriter comfortable. It is not just a record rent. It is a signal that the building can command pricing power at the top of the market, which in turn supports the valuation that justifies a \$1.8 billion loan. For Bank of America, the question is not whether office is back.

The question is whether this specific asset can generate enough income to service this specific debt. The answer, based on the rent roll, appears to be yes. Who benefits? Soloviev Group gains liquidity and time. The refinancing removes maturity pressure and gives the sponsor breathing room to focus on the larger strategic question: what to do with the massive assemblage across the street at Nos.



6-24 West 57th Street, one of the largest empty lots in central Manhattan. That project - whether an anchor office tenant or a condo-hotel - is the real capital event waiting to happen. This refinancing buys the time to get it right. Who is exposed? Every other office owner hoping this deal signals a broad reopening of bank lending. It does not. Bank of America is not underwriting the office sector.

It is underwriting a specific asset with a specific rent roll and a specific sponsor. Owners of Class B and C office assets with vacancy, deferred maintenance, or floating-rate debt should not mistake this transaction for a market-wide thaw. What should the market watch next? The assemblage across the street.

If Soloviev can secure an anchor tenant or a development partner for that site, it would be a much stronger signal about the future of 57th Street than any refinancing. For now, the refinancing is a reminder that capital is available for assets that have already proven their cash flow. The rest of the market is still waiting for its turn.

# About Us

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Light Tower Group is a commercial real estate capital advisory firm helping owners, developers, and investors structure and source debt, preferred equity, joint venture equity, and other institutional capital solutions.

We work across acquisitions, refinancings, recapitalizations, and development projects, with a focus on clear strategy, credible execution, and capital that fits the deal.

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